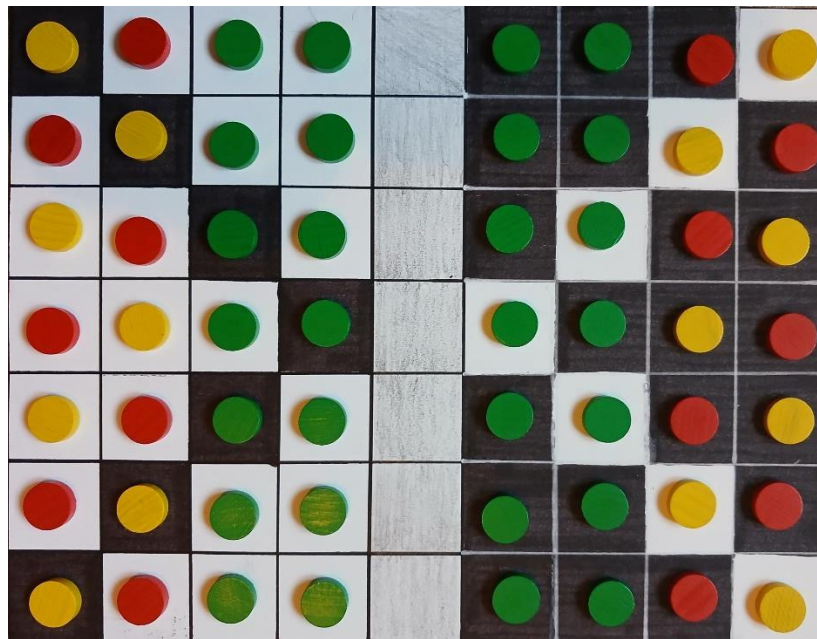


Jeu des Rôdeurs (Rovers' Game)

2025, Xavier Bultel, <https://bultel.info/Rodeurs.html>



initial setup

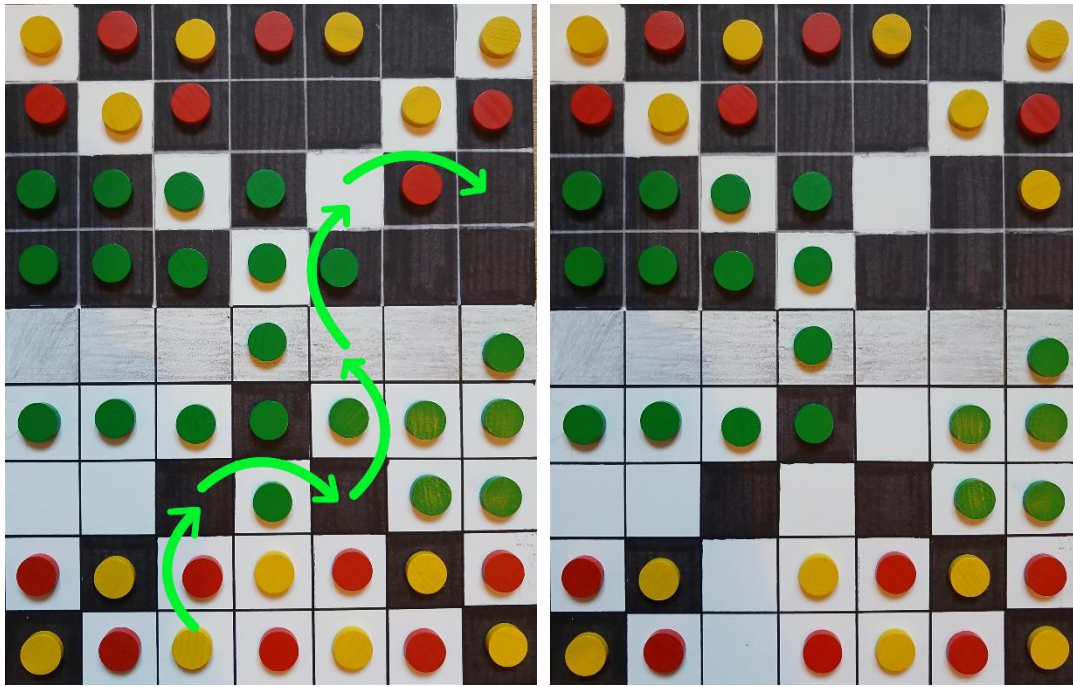
The white squares are called the “district” of the starting player, and the black squares are called the “district” of their opponent.

On each turn, the player must move pieces by “jumping” over other pieces. A jump consists of moving a piece in a straight line over two squares to an empty square, passing over a square occupied by another piece. The jumped piece is removed from the board.

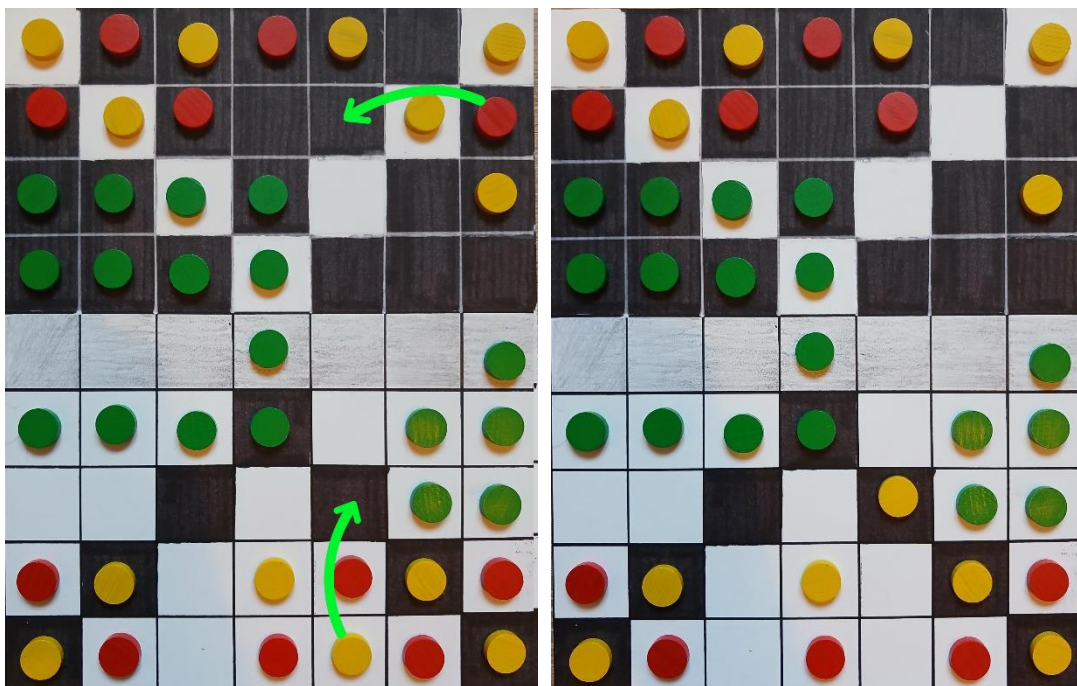
On the first turn, the player performs a single jump with any piece of their choice. For each subsequent turn, the player may choose between the following two actions:

- Two jumps: The player performs two successive jumps with two pieces of their choice.
- Multiple jump: The player performs several successive jumps with a single piece of their choice. There is no limit to the number of jumps; the player may make as many successive jumps as they wish as long as it is possible (they may also perform just a single jump).

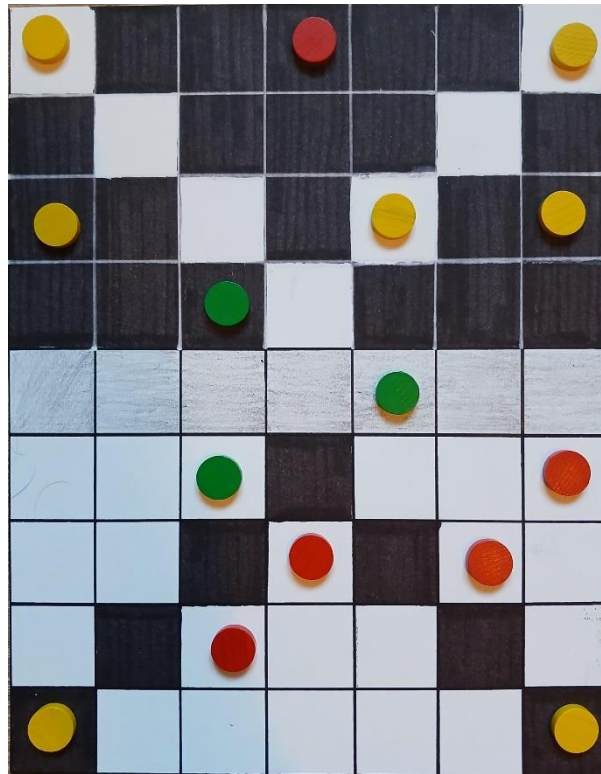
Goal. The game ends when no pieces can be moved. The player with the fewest points wins. In case of a tie, the player with more red rovers in their district loses. If there is still a tie, the player with the most yellow rovers in their district loses. If both districts contain the same number of rovers of each color, the game ends in a draw.



In the first image, the green arrows indicate a possible multiple jump in the given position. The second image shows the state of the board after this multiple jump.



In the first image, the green arrows indicate a possible combination of two jumps in the given position. The second image shows the state of the board after these two jumps.



In this position, no more moves are possible; the game is therefore over. On the black squares, there are 1 green piece, 4 yellow pieces, and 1 red piece, giving a total of $1 + 4 \times 2 + 3 = 12$ points. On the white squares, there are 1 green piece, 3 yellow pieces, and 4 red pieces, giving a total of $1 + 3 \times 2 + 4 \times 3 = 19$ points. The player controlling the black district therefore wins the game.